dispatched his wife and infant son to safety, in India. He was left alone in Bannu, waiting to hand over charge. After that was done, the new Brigade Commander, Brig. Hayauddin discreetly moved Kalkat to house arrest in the Dalipgarh Fort in Bannu. Maj. Kalkat had been overheard talking to Brig. Murray by the head clerk at the brigade headquarters; he had betrayed Kalkat to Pakistani military intelligence. However, some of Kalkat's faithful Muslim soldiers, apprehending that he would be killed, hatched a plan to smuggle him out of the fort and the town on the night of 22 September 1947. They drove him to the Bannu railway station in a truck, from where he took a narrow-gauge train to Mari Indus, a major railhead 150 km away. Mari Indus was the location where Hindus and Sikhs leaving for India by train, got together.

However, early next morning, the duty officer discovered that Kalkat had escaped, he was soon traced to the town of Mari Indus. The British had established a big Army Service Corps depot at Mari Indus to serve troops stationed in Bannu, Tank, Kohat and Waziristan. Maj. Kalkat immediately went to the depot and reported to the British Base Commander that he planned to go to India, after having handed over charge in Bannu. He feared for his life and, despite urgent requests from Bannu asking for his return, the British Base Commander refused to hand him back. The kind British officer provided Maj. Kalkat with a rucksack full of provisions and armed him with his own service weapons. Finally, Kalkat boarded a goods train bound for Amritsar and concealed in one of the bogeys, he finally reached Amritsar and made haste to Delhi, arriving there on 18 October 1947.